Science on the Court (SOTC) — Comprehensive Operations Policy Manual

Djola, LLC dba Science on the Court Adopted: July 22, 2026

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1. Introduction

1.1 About Science on the Court

Science on the Court (SOTC) is a youth sports-based STEM enrichment program operated by Djola, LLC, a California limited liability company, since 2019. Our mission is to bridge the gap between physical education and STEM learning by integrating basketball and science instruction into engaging, memorable educational experiences for youth.

SOTC operates in partnership with East Bay schools, community centers, and youth-serving organizations — including sites affiliated with the Oakland Unified School District, the Boys & Girls Clubs of San Leandro, Allen Temple Baptist Church, and Safe Passages — delivering structured after-school and summer programming at host facilities. Our programs serve students ages 7–18, with age-appropriate curricula aligned to national standards in both STEM subjects and physical education.

Key aspects of our program include:

- Hands-on experiments related to sports physics, biology, and chemistry
- Integration of mathematical concepts in game strategies and statistics
- Exploration of technology in sports equipment and performance analysis
- Development of critical thinking and problem-solving skills through team-based challenges

Since 2019, SOTC has served hundreds of students across East Bay school and community sites, with a track record of improving both STEM comprehension and physical fitness among participants.

1.2 Purpose of This Manual

This operations policy manual is the cornerstone of Science on the Court's day-to-day operations. Its primary purposes are:

1. **Standardization of Procedures:** To ensure consistency in program delivery, safety protocols, and administrative processes across all SOTC program sites.
2. **Legal and Ethical Compliance:** To outline and enforce policies that adhere to all relevant local, state, and federal laws, particularly those pertaining to child safety and youth-serving organizations (including California's AB 506 requirements for youth service organizations).
3. **Quality Assurance:** To maintain high standards in our educational offerings and organizational management.

4. **Risk Management:** To identify potential risks associated with our operations and establish clear protocols for mitigating them, protecting both our participants and the organization.
5. **Staff Guidance:** To serve as a comprehensive resource for all employees, contractors, and volunteers, clearly communicating expectations, responsibilities, and best practices.
6. **Stakeholder Transparency:** To provide a clear overview of our operations to parents, partnering organizations, and host sites, demonstrating our commitment to excellence and safety.

This manual is a living document, subject to regular review and updates. All SOTC personnel — employees, contracted instructors, and volunteers — are required to familiarize themselves with this manual and adhere to the policies within. Each signs an acknowledgment of receipt and review (see Section 3.2), which is retained in their personnel file.

1.3 Core Values

1. **Safety First:** The physical and emotional well-being of our participants and staff is our paramount concern.
2. **Educational Excellence:** High-quality, engaging STEM education that complements classroom learning.
3. **Inclusivity and Diversity:** An environment where all students, regardless of background, ability, or prior experience, can thrive — with deliberate outreach to groups underrepresented in STEM.
4. **Innovation in Learning:** Creative blending of sports and STEM education.
5. **Ethical Conduct:** Integrity, professionalism, transparent practices, and honest communication with all stakeholders.
6. **Community Engagement:** Collaboration with local schools, community organizations, and families to create a network of support for our participants.
7. **Continuous Improvement:** Ongoing evaluation and refinement of programs, policies, and practices.

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2. Organizational Structure

2.1 Ownership and Governance

Science on the Court is operated by Djola, LLC, a single-member California limited liability company. The sole member serves as Executive Director and holds final legal and financial authority for the organization.

2.2 Advisory Board

SOTC maintains an Advisory Board of three to seven members drawn from education, youth development, science, athletics, and the East Bay community. The Advisory Board serves in a non-fiduciary, advisory capacity:

1. **Program Guidance:** Advising on curriculum quality, program design, and educational standards.
2. **Community Connections:** Supporting partnerships with schools, community organizations, and funders.
3. **Safety and Policy Review:** Reviewing this manual and SOTC's child-protection practices at least annually and recommending improvements.

4. **Strategic Input:** Advising on growth, staffing, and long-term direction.

The Advisory Board meets at least twice per year. Advisory Board members who have direct contact with program participants are screened to the same standard as staff and volunteers (Section 3).

2.3 Executive Leadership

Executive Director. The Executive Director is the chief executive of SOTC and is responsible for:

- Overall management of operations, programs, personnel, and finances
- Serving as the **Designated Child Safety Officer** (Section 4.4) and the **IIPP Administrator** (Section 5)
- Hiring, contracting, screening, and supervising all personnel
- Relationships with host sites, partner organizations, and families
- Compliance with all legal, contractual, and insurance requirements

Executive Assistant. A part-time employee providing remote administrative support: scheduling, communications, registration administration, records, and program materials. The Executive Assistant works remotely and has no in-person contact with program participants.

2.4 Staff Categories

1. **Employees.** SOTC's employed staff is intentionally small; currently a part-time Executive Assistant (remote, administrative). Employees receive California-mandated paid sick leave and any other benefits required by law.
2. **Contracted Instructors (Coaches).** Independent contractors engaged per program or per session to lead SOTC's sports and STEM instruction at host sites. Coaches instruct and demonstrate; they do not play. Contracted instructors are not employees of SOTC and are responsible for their own taxes; each signs an independent-contractor agreement, the SOTC Code of Conduct, and completes the full screening process (Section 3) before any participant contact. **Contracted instructors are required to carry their own liability insurance; a current certificate of insurance is collected at engagement and verified annually as part of the contractor file.**
3. **Volunteers.** Volunteers support program delivery as assistant instructors, help with administrative tasks, and assist at special events and community outreach. **Regular volunteers** — adults who serve 16 or more hours in a month or 32 or more hours in a year, the threshold set by California AB 506 — complete the same screening, background check, and Tier A training requirements as paid personnel before working with SOTC participants (Sections 3 and 6). **Occasional volunteers** below that threshold (for example a parent helping at a single showcase) sign the Code of Conduct, receive a site orientation, are never alone with a participant, and are never counted toward adult-supervision ratios. Volunteers under 18 are not placed in supervisory roles and require a signed parent/guardian waiver.

Site lead. At each program site, the Executive Director designates a lead coach ("Site Lead") responsible for daily safety implementation, sign-in/out oversight, and incident reporting at that site.

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3. Staff Requirements and Hiring Process

3.1 General Requirements

All personnel associated with Science on the Court — employees, contracted instructors, and volunteers — must meet the following criteria:

1. **Age:** At least 18 years of age for any instructional or supervisory role. (Minor volunteers, where used, serve only in non-supervisory support roles under direct adult supervision and are never counted toward adult-supervision ratios.)
2. **Education:** High school diploma or equivalent; for instructional roles, relevant experience or coursework in STEM fields, education, or sports instruction is preferred.
3. **Background Check:** Successful completion of the full screening process in Section 3.3 before any participant contact.
4. **References:** Professional and/or personal references who can speak to the candidate's character and suitability for working with children (Section 3.4).
5. **Skills:** Demonstrated ability to work effectively with children and adolescents; strong communication; commitment to SOTC's mission and Code of Conduct.
6. **Physical Requirements:** Ability to perform the physical aspects of the role (standing for extended periods, light lifting up to 25 lbs, demonstrating drills). Reasonable accommodations are made for individuals with disabilities.
7. **Legal Right to Work:** Documentation of eligibility to work in the United States (employees and contractors).
8. **Certifications:** Role-dependent certifications (e.g., First Aid/CPR) as specified in Section 6.

3.2 Application and Screening Process

Standard Application. All applicants — employment, contractor, or volunteer — complete the SOTC application, which collects identity and contact information, educational background, relevant experience with youth, employment/activity history, disclosure of any criminal history, and references. **All applications contain a clear notice that a criminal background check will be conducted and that applicants may be rejected or terminated based on an unacceptable result.** Applicants sign a certification that all information provided is true and complete; false statements or material omissions are grounds for disqualification or dismissal.

Code of Conduct Acknowledgment. Before beginning work, every employee, contractor, and volunteer reviews and signs the SOTC Code of Conduct, covering: commitment to child safety and the policies in Section 4; professional boundaries; confidentiality; ethical behavior; non-discrimination; zero tolerance for substance abuse during programs; conflict-of-interest disclosure; social media and communication rules; and mandatory reporting obligations. **Each individual also signs an acknowledgment that they have read this manual, including the written abuse-prevention policies in Section 4; signed acknowledgments are retained permanently in personnel files.**

Interviews. The Executive Director (or a designated Site Lead) conducts a structured interview with every candidate, assessing experience working with youth, STEM and coaching ability, judgment in behavioral scenarios,

and fit with SOTC's values. Instructional candidates may be asked to deliver a short sample lesson integrating a STEM concept with a sports activity.

3.3 Criminal Background Checks

Ensuring participant safety is paramount. **All employees, contracted instructors, and regular volunteers (§2.4) must complete and clear the following before beginning work and before any contact with participants:**

1. **Live Scan Fingerprint Check (California DOJ + FBI).** Ten-digit fingerprint-based check through California's Live Scan system, covering state (CA DOJ) and national (FBI) criminal history. Consistent with California AB 506 requirements for youth service organizations.
2. **National Sex Offender Registry Check.** Screening against state and national sex offender registries for all employees, contractors, and volunteers. **Each individual signs an acknowledgment that they may be rejected or terminated if a sex offender match occurs.**
3. **Name-Based National Criminal Database Search.** Multi-state database search, including SSN trace, as a supplement to fingerprint results.
4. **Additional checks where applicable:** county criminal record checks for counties of residence; education/credential verification for roles where credentials are claimed.

Process. The applicant signs a consent form; SOTC initiates checks through its authorized provider; results are reviewed in strict confidence by the Executive Director; applicants may dispute inaccurate information. No individual works or volunteers with SOTC until all checks are completed and cleared.

Evaluating results. Any history of violence, sexual offenses, or crimes against children results in automatic disqualification. Other results are evaluated case by case (nature and gravity of the offense, time elapsed, relevance to the role, evidence of rehabilitation), in compliance with the Fair Credit Reporting Act and California law, always prioritizing participant safety.

Rescreening. Sex-offender registry and criminal database checks are repeated **annually** for all active personnel. All personnel must self-report any arrest, charge, or conviction occurring between checks. Records of all background checks are retained **permanently** in confidential files.

3.4 Reference Checks

Reference checks are completed for all employees and contracted instructors (and for volunteers in instructional roles) before participant contact:

- **Standardized abuse-risk questions** are asked of every reference, including: "How would you describe the applicant's interactions with children or youth?"; "Are you aware of any instances where the applicant's behavior with minors was questioned or caused concern?"; "Would you have any hesitation recommending this person for a position of trust with children?"
- **Professional references** (minimum two) verify work history and performance, with specific attention to work with children.

- **Personal references** are used where professional references are limited; they must not be family members and must have known the applicant at least two years.
- **Documentation.** Every reference conversation is documented on a standardized form (date, reference identity and relationship, summary, any red flags, recommendation) and retained in the applicant's confidential file.

3.5 Hiring Decision and Onboarding

The Executive Director makes the final decision based on the application, interview, background check results, and references. Offers (or contractor engagements) are contingent on completion of all screening. Onboarding includes: review of this manual with signed acknowledgment; child safety and abuse-prevention training (Section 6); site orientation and emergency procedures; introduction to curriculum and program materials; and, for the first program cycle, observation and check-ins by the Executive Director or Site Lead.

3.6 Ongoing Screening and Monitoring

- **Annual rescreening** (Section 3.3) of all active personnel.
- **Continuous self-reporting** of arrests, charges, or convictions.
- **Observation.** The Executive Director or Site Lead periodically observes sessions to confirm adherence to safety protocols and instructional standards.
- **Feedback channels.** Participants and parents are actively encouraged to raise any concern about staff conduct (Section 4.4); concerns may be raised anonymously.
- **Credential verification.** Annual verification of required certifications (e.g., CPR/First Aid currency).

3.7 Driver Authorization (MVR and Personal Auto Insurance)

SOTC staff, contractors, and volunteers never transport participants (Section 4.1), and SOTC owns no vehicles; field-trip transportation uses insured third-party charter carriers only. Incidental driving on SOTC business may nonetheless occur (e.g., travel between program sites, transporting equipment or materials). Before any individual — including the Executive Director — drives on behalf of the organization, the following driver authorization is completed:

- **License verification.** A valid driver's license is confirmed (number, class, and expiration recorded).
- **Motor Vehicle Record (MVR).** A current MVR (California DMV driver record, or the equivalent for an out-of-state license) is obtained and reviewed by the Executive Director. Disqualifying results include: a suspended or revoked license; a DUI or reckless-driving conviction within the past five years; or a pattern of moving violations (three or more within three years).
- **Personal auto liability insurance.** Proof of current personal auto liability insurance meeting at least California statutory minimum limits is collected (declarations page or insurance ID card), with the policy number and expiration recorded.
- **Re-verification.** Driver authorization is renewed annually (with the September rescreen cycle) and whenever a license or policy on file expires. Drivers must self-report any license suspension, DUI, or major violation occurring between verifications.

- **Records.** Completed Driver Authorization forms, MVRs, and insurance proof are retained in the personnel file (Section 5.6a).

Individuals who have not completed driver authorization may not drive on SOTC business. Driving to and from one's own workplace or program site as a commute is not "driving on behalf of the organization" and does not require authorization.

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4. Child Protection and Safety Policies

4.1 Two-Adult Rule

Policy Statement. At least two screened adults must be present with participants at all times during SOTC activities. No SOTC employee, contractor, or volunteer may be alone with a participant. This policy protects both participants and staff and ensures proper supervision.

Implementation.

- All program spaces are set up for clear lines of sight; doors remain open unless a window provides clear visibility into the room.
- Where a brief one-on-one interaction is necessary (e.g., first aid), it occurs in an open, visible space with another adult nearby.
- Restrooms: adults accompany groups of children to restroom areas and remain outside the door, in view of another adult.
- SOTC programs operate at host facilities (schools, community centers) where host-site staff are typically also present; host staff presence supplements but never replaces SOTC's own two-adult coverage.
- **SOTC staff, contractors, and volunteers never transport participants in personal vehicles.** Parents/guardians (or the host site's own program) are responsible for participant travel to and from all regular program locations. For occasional field trips, SOTC uses licensed, insured third-party charter bus companies only; before each trip SOTC obtains the carrier's certificate of insurance, additional-insured status, and a written agreement with hold-harmless/indemnification language, collects signed parent/guardian permission slips, and ensures at least two screened adults accompany participants on every vehicle. Any individual who drives on SOTC business in any other capacity (never with participants) must first complete driver authorization — MVR and personal auto insurance verification — per Section 3.7.

Exceptions and Contingencies.

- In an emergency where following the two-adult rule would delay urgently needed action, staff prioritize child safety while involving another adult as soon as possible.
- Any unavoidable one-on-one interaction must be documented and reported to the Executive Director immediately.
- If unforeseen circumstances leave only one adult present, the activity moves to an open area within view of host-site staff, or is ended early if that is not possible.

4.2 Abuse Prevention Policy

- **Zero tolerance.** SOTC has a zero-tolerance policy for any form of abuse or molestation — physical, emotional, or sexual — of any participant. The policy communicates a zero-tolerance approach to inappropriate behaviors, defines appropriate and inappropriate behaviors (Sections 4.3 and 4.6), and commits SOTC to investigate and cooperate fully with law enforcement.
- Any staff member, contractor, or volunteer found to have engaged in abuse or molestation is immediately terminated and reported to appropriate authorities. Individuals under investigation are removed from all participant contact pending resolution and are not retained on active duty.
- **Mandated reporters.** All SOTC staff, contractors, and volunteers are mandated reporters under California law (CANRA, as extended by AB 506 to youth service organizations) and must immediately report any suspicion of abuse or neglect to the appropriate authorities and to the Designated Child Safety Officer.
- Every employee, contractor, and volunteer signs an acknowledgment that they have read and will follow these abuse-prevention policies; records are retained permanently.

4.3 Physical Contact Guidelines

Appropriate physical contact is limited, in view of others, with the participant's verbal consent, and for a clear instructional or safety purpose: high-fives and fist bumps; shoulder or upper-back pats; handshakes; spotting or physical guidance during sports activities (with verbal explanation and consent first); brief side hugs in full view of others, initiated by the child.

Prohibited physical contact: kisses of any kind; full-frontal hugs or prolonged embraces; lap-sitting; touching of private body parts (except medical necessity by qualified personnel); wrestling or tickling; piggyback rides; any form of unwanted touch; physical punishment or discipline.

Specific situations.

- *Sports instruction:* demonstrate with another staff member rather than a participant where possible; when physical guidance is necessary, explain verbally first and ask permission; use minimal contact for the shortest time necessary.
- *Comforting a distressed child:* offer verbal reassurance first; if physical comfort is needed, side hugs or upper-back pats in full view of others; alert another staff member.
- *Personal care assistance* is not part of SOTC programming; participants requiring such assistance are referred to their parent/guardian or host-site staff.

Reporting violations. All staff must immediately report observed violations of these guidelines to the Site Lead or Executive Director. Participants and parents are encouraged to report any uncomfortable interaction. All reports are investigated, with action up to termination and reporting to authorities.

4.4 Formal Reporting Procedures

SOTC maintains formal reporting procedures for employees, contractors, volunteers, participants, families, and third parties to raise complaints, grievances, and suspected abuse.

Types of reports: suspected misconduct, abuse, or molestation (adult-to-child); policy violations or suspicious behavior not rising to abuse; abuse or sexualized behavior between minors (child-to-child); policy violations generally; ethical concerns; harassment or discrimination; safety hazards; general complaints.

Reporting channels.

1. **Designated Child Safety Officer** (the Executive Director): primary contact for any child-safety concern. If a concern involves the Executive Director personally, reports go directly to law enforcement / Child Protective Services and may also be raised with any Advisory Board member.
2. **Site Lead:** for site-level or non-urgent matters.
3. **Anonymous reporting:** concerns may be submitted anonymously in writing or through SOTC's posted reporting contact.
4. **Authorities:** mandated reporters report suspected abuse directly to law enforcement or CPS as required by law — internal reporting never replaces or delays a legal report.

Process — suspected abuse (adult-to-child): report immediately to authorities and the Child Safety Officer; document the incident in detail (date, time, location, individuals); do not investigate further or confront the accused; the accused is immediately removed from all participant contact pending investigation; cooperate fully with authorities; parents/guardians of affected children are notified consistent with authorities' guidance.

Process — child-to-child incidents: intervene immediately to ensure all children's safety; separate the individuals involved; report to the Child Safety Officer; document, assess (ages, development, power imbalance), notify parents/guardians of all children involved; implement interventions (increased supervision, counseling referrals, program adjustments); involve authorities where required.

Protections. Retaliation against good-faith reporters is strictly prohibited. Knowingly false allegations violate SOTC policy and may result in disciplinary action.

Record keeping. All reports, investigations, and actions taken are documented and stored securely with access limited to those directly involved; **incident and allegation records are retained permanently.**

Training. All personnel receive training on these reporting procedures at onboarding and in annual refreshers.

4.5 Communication Policies and Professional Boundaries

- All communication with participants occurs through official SOTC channels (SOTC email, official phone number, approved platforms, official social media for general announcements only).
- Prohibited: sharing personal contact information with participants; communicating via personal social media; private messages to individual participants without copying a parent or another staff member; informal, suggestive, or personal content; "friending"/"following" current participants on personal accounts.
- Any necessary individual communication is documented, copied to a parent or the Executive Director, and limited to program matters.
- Staff must not post pictures or information about participants on personal accounts. Tagging or identifying participants on SOTC accounts requires explicit parental consent (see media release, Section 4.7).
- Staff maintain professional boundaries at all times: no personal relationships with participants outside SOTC programs; no babysitting, private tutoring/coaching, home visits, meals, or travel with participants; no gifts to

or from participants; appropriate verbal interactions only (no shaming, profanity, off-color jokes, requests to keep secrets, or inappropriate personal disclosures).
- Parent emails go through SOTC accounts; staff respond to parent inquiries within 24 business hours; significant parent concerns are documented and shared with the Executive Director.

4.6 Program Boundaries

- SOTC provides no in-home services. All program activities take place at approved host facilities.
- SOTC does not operate residential programs or overnight activities, and does not own or operate vehicles; field-trip transportation is provided only by contracted, insured charter carriers per Section 4.1.
- Emergency communication: program-wide emergencies are communicated to parents by text, email, and phone as urgency requires; for individual participant emergencies, the primary guardian is called immediately, followed by the emergency contact list, with all attempts documented. Staff never release emergency information to media or unauthorized individuals.

4.7 Enrollment, Registration, and Sign-In/Out

Registration. Parents/guardians register participants through SOTC's registration process, providing: participant and guardian contact information; emergency contacts; relevant medical information and allergies; a signed liability waiver and consent form; **a signed media release** (photo/likeness consent — participation in photos is optional and never a condition of enrollment); and an authorized pick-up list. Need-based fee assistance and payment plans are available; recipients are expected to maintain regular attendance.

Sign-in/sign-out. Each site maintains sign-in/out records (electronic or paper) recording arrival and departure times. At dismissal, participants are released only to adults on the authorized pick-up list; staff verify identity (photo ID if not recognized). Older participants (with written parental authorization) may sign themselves out where the host site permits.

Late pick-up. A 15-minute grace period applies after scheduled end time; after the grace period, a late fee of $1 per minute applies. If a child is not picked up within 30 minutes, staff attempt to contact all authorized pick-up individuals; if no contact is made within 1 hour, local authorities may be notified. Every late-pickup incident is documented and reviewed with the family; repeated occurrences may result in suspension from the program. Two adults always remain with any child awaiting pick-up.

4.8 Program Schedule and Structure

- **After-school sessions** (core program): typically 60–90 minutes at host sites, combining warm-up and sports activity, hands-on STEM instruction, and integrated STEM-sports activities, with age-banded groups (7–10, 11–13, 14–18).
- **Summer sessions:** multi-week structured programming at host sites during summer, following the same session structure and staffing rules.
- **Weekend or school-break programming** is offered only when contracted with a host site, under the same policies.
- All sessions follow the two-adult rule, sign-in/out procedures, and the safety protocols in Section 5.

5. Injury and Illness Prevention Program (IIPP)

Science on the Court maintains this written Injury and Illness Prevention Program in accordance with Cal/OSHA requirements (8 CCR §3203). It establishes procedures to identify, evaluate, and control hazards that could result in injury or illness during SOTC programs and activities.

5.1 Responsibility and Authority

- **IIPP Administrator:** the Executive Director, with authority and responsibility for implementing and maintaining this program — ensuring implementation of all IIPP procedures; conducting or directing safety inspections and hazard assessments; investigating accidents, injuries, and near-misses; maintaining safety training records; coordinating with medical and emergency services; and reviewing/updating the IIPP annually or as needed.
- **Site Leads:** responsible at each program site for daily implementation of safety procedures, site-specific safety briefings, proper use and condition of equipment, maintaining first aid supplies, and reporting hazards and incidents to the IIPP Administrator.
- **All personnel** (employees, contractors, volunteers) are responsible for following safety procedures, reporting unsafe conditions immediately, attending required safety training, and assisting in emergency response.
- **Communication and compliance:** safety matters are communicated through onboarding, site briefings, and program communications; employees may report hazards anonymously without fear of reprisal; compliance with safe work practices is a condition of work with SOTC.

5.2 Hazard Identification and Assessment

- Safety walk-throughs of each program space at the start of every session; periodic documented inspections of all program sites; assessment before introducing any new activity or equipment; incident-triggered assessments after any accident or near-miss.
- **Common hazards in SOTC programs:**
- *Physical activity:* slips/trips/falls on playing surfaces; collisions during sports; overexertion and heat-related illness; impact injuries from equipment.
- *Science activity:* the SOTC curriculum uses classroom-safe demonstrations; hazards include minor cuts, spills, and misuse of materials. SOTC does not use laboratory chemicals requiring specialized ventilation or storage.
- *Environmental:* extreme weather during outdoor activities; poor air quality days; inadequate lighting; facility conditions at host sites.
- *Equipment/facility:* faulty or poorly maintained sports equipment; structural or housekeeping issues at host facilities (reported to the host site immediately).

5.3 Hazard Control Measures

SOTC follows the hierarchy of controls (elimination, substitution, engineering, administrative, PPE):

- *Physical activity controls:* mandatory warm-up and cool-down; inspection of playing surfaces and equipment before use; weather monitoring with modification/cancellation protocols (including air-quality and heat criteria); hydration breaks every 20–30 minutes during physical activity; age-appropriate activity modifications and equipment sizing.
- *Science activity controls:* only age-appropriate, classroom-safe materials; safety goggles for any activity involving projectiles, liquids, or debris; adult demonstration before student participation; materials stored out of reach between sessions; prompt spill cleanup.
- *PPE:* safety goggles for applicable science activities; closed-toe shoes mandatory for all participants and staff; sun protection for outdoor activities.

5.4 Emergency Response Procedures

- **Medical emergency:** assess scene safety; determine severity; call 911 immediately for life-threatening emergencies; administer first aid within scope of training; do not move an injured person unless there is immediate danger; notify the Site Lead immediately, parents/guardians as soon as practical, and the IIPP Administrator within 1 hour; document all actions.
- **Severe weather / air quality:** monitor forecasts and alerts; move activities indoors when lightning is within 6 miles; cancel or modify outdoor activities per established heat and air-quality criteria; follow host-facility shelter procedures.
- **Facility emergencies (fire, evacuation, lockdown):** follow the host site's posted emergency procedures; Site Leads review these procedures at each site and brief staff; account for all participants using sign-in records at assembly points.

5.5 Training and Education

- **New personnel:** IIPP overview and responsibilities; hazard recognition and reporting; emergency response protocols; site-specific procedures.
- **Ongoing:** safety review at the start of each program cycle; refresher training on emergency procedures; activity-specific training before new programs; documented completion records.
- **Participants:** brief safety instructions before activities; age-appropriate safety content integrated into programming; regular reminders on equipment use and rules.

5.6 Incident Investigation and Documentation

- **Report immediately:** any injury requiring medical attention; near-misses; property damage; unsafe conditions or equipment failures.
- **Investigation:** secure the scene; gather information and witness accounts; document evidence (photographs where appropriate); identify root causes; implement corrective actions; follow up to confirm effectiveness.
- **Documentation:** incident reports completed within 24 hours; investigation findings within 72 hours; medical treatment records maintained; corrective action plans with owners and timelines; **incident reports and documentation of actions retained permanently**; annual review of incidents and trends.

5.6a Records Retention and Destruction Policy

SOTC maintains and makes available the following records retention and destruction schedule:

- **Retained permanently:** incident and injury reports and investigation documentation; abuse-related reports, allegations, and actions taken; personnel files including background check records, signed policy acknowledgments, and training certificates.
- **Retained at least 7 years:** contracts, insurance policies and certificates, financial and tax records.
- **Retained for the program year plus 3 years:** participant registrations, waivers, media releases, sign-in/out records, and attendance logs.
- **Destruction:** records past their retention period that contain personal information are destroyed securely (shredding or verified digital deletion). Records subject to any known claim, investigation, or litigation hold are never destroyed until the matter fully concludes.
- Access to all retained records is limited to the Executive Director and those with a need to know; records are stored in secured (password-protected or locked) locations.

5.7 Program Evaluation and Improvement

The IIPP is reviewed at least annually — assessing the effectiveness of safety measures, incident trends, program or site changes, and new regulatory requirements — and updated as needed. SOTC benchmarks against practices of similar youth-serving organizations and incorporates staff and family feedback.

5.8 Early Return-to-Work Program

SOTC supports employees who sustain work-related injuries through an early return-to-work program designed to facilitate safe, timely return to productive work while promoting healing.

- **Coordinator:** the Executive Director coordinates all aspects of the return-to-work process, maintains communication with the injured employee and healthcare providers, and keeps confidential records.
- **Immediate response:** ensure immediate medical attention (911 for serious injuries); complete an incident report within 24 hours; report to the workers' compensation carrier within required timeframes; provide the employee with workers' compensation information and rights; initial contact with the injured employee within 24–48 hours.
- **Medical management:** provide the treating physician with job descriptions and physical requirements; request specific work restrictions and capabilities; obtain written work-status reports; final medical clearance before return to full duty.
- **Transitional work:** modified-duty opportunities matched to restrictions — administrative tasks, curriculum development and research, training-material preparation, equipment inventory (within limitations), event planning, communications support — with reduced physical demands, modified schedules, and remote options where feasible. Transitional arrangements are documented in a written return-to-work agreement (restrictions, accommodations, expectations, review dates) signed by the employee and the Executive Director.
- **Monitoring:** regular contact during the return period (weekly during the initial return, then as needed); progress documented; accommodations adjusted as the medical condition improves.

- **Rights and responsibilities:** employees have the right to appropriate medical care, workers' compensation benefits as provided by law, confidential handling of medical information, accommodation consistent with restrictions, and protection from retaliation for filing claims. Employees are responsible for prompt and accurate injury reporting, following prescribed care and restrictions, and active participation in the process.
- **Compliance:** all return-to-work activities comply with applicable federal and state law; medical information is kept confidential; accommodations follow ADA/FEHA guidelines; workers' compensation reporting meets all regulatory requirements.

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6. Required Training Modules

Revised November 4, 2026. Supersedes the eight-module table adopted July 22, 2026.

SOTC requires a small core of training that law, host-site contracts, and SOTC's insurance attestations actually depend on, and encourages further training by reimbursing it. Certificates of completion are provided to SOTC and **retained in personnel files**. Failure to complete required training within the specified timeframe results in suspension from participant interaction or termination of employment/contract.

6.1 Tier A — Required of every adult with regular participant contact

Applies to the Executive Director, contracted instructors (coaches), Site Leads, and regular adult volunteers (defined in §2.4). A1 and A3 are completed **before any participant contact**; A2 is completed **within 30 days of the first day of participant contact**. A coach who passes the 30-day mark without the A2 certificate on file is suspended from participant contact until it is.

#	Training	Where to take it	Cost · time · evidence	Renewal
A1	**California Mandated Reporter Training** — General module for everyone; **School Personnel module** in addition for anyone placed at an OUSD or other school-district site (the certificate OUSD and Safe Passages accept)	mandatedreporterca.com/Training (CA DSS; satisfies AB 506)	Free · 2–4 h · certificate downloads at the end of each module	Annually
A2	**SafeSport® Trained Core** — abuse prevention in sports and youth programs, including boundaries, bullying,	safesporttrained.org — Sign up, enter **N/A** as organization ID, open Catalog, purchase "SafeSport Trained Core"	$20 · 90 min · certificate valid 12 months	**Within 30 days of first participant contact**; then annually (Refresher 1–3, then Core again in year 5)

#	Training	Where to take it	Cost · time · evidence	Renewal
	hazing, harassment and peer-to-peer misconduct			
A3	**SOTC onboarding** — signed acknowledgment of this manual and its abuse-prevention policies (§3.2); site orientation and the host site's emergency procedures before the first session at each site	Executive Director or Site Lead	Free · about 1 h · signed packet page + orientation sign-off	Acknowledgment once; orientation each program cycle

6.2 Tier B — Required additionally for Site Leads and the Executive Director

#	Training	Where to take it	Cost · time · evidence	Renewal
B1	**CPR and First Aid** — Adult & Pediatric First Aid/CPR/AED	American Red Cross, Oakland classes (blended) or YMCA of the East Bay	About $75–110 · 2–3 h online + 2 h in person · 2-year card	Every 2 years

At least one CPR/First Aid-certified SOTC adult is present at every session. A coach who is the only SOTC adult at a site is the Site Lead for that site and must hold B1 before leading alone.

6.3 Tier C — Encouraged and reimbursed, not a condition of participant contact

#	Training	Where to take it	Cost · time	Best for
C1	**Classroom Behavior Management, Part 1 and Part 2 (Elementary)**	IRIS Center, Vanderbilt — free account, pre/post-test, certificate	Free · about 2 h per module	Anyone leading grades K–5; strongly encouraged before a coach leads a room alone
C2	**Stewards of Children®** — child sexual abuse prevention	d2l.org/training-catalog/stewards-of-children (Darkness to Light)	$16 · 2.5 h	Site Leads; anyone who wants to lead a site
C3	**Youth Protection Training**	my.scouting.org (Scouting America; free, no membership needed)	Free · about 75 min	All coaches
C4	**Peer Abuse Prevention**	American Camp Association / Redwoods Group	$10 · about 1 h	Coaches running multi-age or overnight-free camp formats

#	Training	Where to take it	Cost · time	Best for
C5	**Positive Discipline in the Classroom** certification	positivediscipline.com	$395	Site Leads with a multi-year role; approved case by case

6.4 Requirements by role

Role	Tier A	Tier B (CPR/First Aid)	Tier C	Live Scan & registry checks (§3.3)
Executive Director	Required	Required	Encouraged	Required
Site Lead (designated coach)	Required	Required	C1 and C2 strongly encouraged	Required
Contracted instructor (coach)	Required	Required only if sole SOTC adult at a site	C1 strongly encouraged	Required
Regular adult volunteer (§2.4)	Required	Not required	Encouraged	Required
Occasional adult volunteer (§2.4)	A3 only (Code of Conduct, orientation); never alone with a participant	Not required	—	Not required by law; two-adult rule applies at all times
Volunteer under 18	A3 only, plus parent/guardian waiver; supervised support role only	Not required	—	Not required; never counted toward adult ratios
Non-contact employee (e.g., remote Executive Assistant)	A1 General module only (AB 506 covers administrators)	Not required	—	Required (§3.3 applies to all employees)

Cost and reimbursement. Tier A costs a new coach $20 and about 5 hours, of which only the free Mandated Reporter modules and the onboarding acknowledgment come before the first session; Tier B about $75–110. SOTC reimburses Tier A and B fees, Tier C fees it has approved in advance, and the Live Scan fee on the person's first invoice after clearance.

Host-site requirements. Where a host site or district requires more than this section (for example OUSD's TB assessment, or a district-specific training), the host requirement applies in addition.

Site Leads additionally review each host site's emergency procedures before the start of each program cycle. SOTC reviews and updates these training requirements regularly to meet the organization's needs and best practices in

youth protection.

Acknowledgment of Receipt and Review

Every employee, contracted instructor, and volunteer acknowledges in writing that they have received, read, and understood this manual, including the child protection and abuse-prevention policies in Section 4, and agrees to comply with all policies and procedures it contains. Violations may result in termination of employment, contract, or volunteer role and, where applicable, reporting to authorities.

Where to sign: the acknowledgment is signed once, in section 1 of the Acknowledgments page (page 3) of the SOTC Personnel Packet, which is completed electronically and submitted through SOTC's secure upload form. This manual itself is not signed.

Signed acknowledgments are retained permanently in personnel files.